

Church History





About the Course

Each year in elementary grades, students read biographies of influential people from church history. This course features the stories of Christians from Alveary's modern history rotation for the years (1800-1900).

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 4-6



Placement & Combining Tips

Those who wish to combine students in Grades 4-6 with younger students should choose either this course or the Church History for grades 1-3. If you have a 6th grader, they could be combined with the 7-8 Church History course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	Church History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 20 min	Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 4-6				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 4-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Church History: Grades 4-6



Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China



Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Church History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Read

- Read the chapter or selection aloud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the students' pace during the lesson, rather than feeling that a particular number of pages must be completed. It is vitally important that teachers not overload students with more material than they can absorb in one sitting.
- Students who have difficulty sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Students with regular difficulty engaging often benefit from having a picture to associate with the story WHILE listening. Feel free to view the artwork during the reading rather than after the narration.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



View

- Optional: Share a piece of fine art that illustrates the story.



Discuss

- Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
-

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

Meeting Hudson Taylor

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ NOTE

This first Church History biography is scheduled for Term 1 and finishes in Term 2, week 6. Pace of reading can be adapted to fit the student, and if additional time is needed to finish the book, there will be time in Term 1's Week 11 and in the final week of assigned reading (Term 2, Week 6).

→ INTRO

This year in Church History, we are reading about Christians from the past who lived between the years 1800-1900 AD. You will read about people who loved God, loved the Bible, and wanted others to know the good news that salvation is found in Jesus Christ. They followed God even when it was hard and they faced difficulty. As you read, think about what ideas inspired them.

The first book we will read is "Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China." Hudson Taylor was a missionary to the people of China and wanted to live for God through a life of prayer and faith in his Savior.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.11-22 "Captain Morris gripped" - "become a Christian."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of young Hudson Taylor

• IMPORTANT DATES

Hudson Taylor born May 1, 1832

WEEK 2 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Learning the Language

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.23-35 "And amazingly, he" - "recommended to me."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the content regarding the Opium War on p.33-34 where addiction to opium is discussed.

WEEK 3 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

The Opportunity of a Lifetime

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.36-48 "And how are" - "go to China."

WEEK 4 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

Waiting for Payday

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ & NARRATE

p.49-60 "Dr Hardey paid" - "was in London."

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Trouble for Hudson

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.61-73 "Instead of having" - "control after all."

- This week and last week's readings have included some ways Taylor trusted God for money and financial support. What do you think about those approaches and ideas?

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

Remain in England?

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.75-86 "Back in Barnsley" - "closer to Shanghai."

WEEK 7 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

China At Last!

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.87-98 "Hudson looked over" - "or a minister?"

- Hudson wrote about the feelings he had as he thought about landing and leaving the Dumfries: "What peculiar feelings arise at the prospect of soon landing in an unknown country, in the midst of strangers—a country now to be my home and sphere of labor..." (p.88) Can you imagine yourself in that situation? What feelings would you have? What would you be hesitant or fearful about? What would you be excited about?

WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

"If Only They Knew the Living God"

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.99-111 "This last question" - "of a war."

• IMPORTANT DATES

1854 - Hudson Taylor arrives in Shanghai, China

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.110 where it discusses beheading and the beliefs the Chinese had about this method of death, as well as the following paragraphs where it discusses injuries the coolies received.

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

One of the Crowd

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-123 "Worst of all" - "in the town."

- Even though Taylor keeps facing very difficult situations, he still wants to be in China. Why? And what is it that motivates him to stay? What do you think about his decision to continue on in China?

→ MAP ACTIVITY

Look at the map at the beginning of the book (unmarked p.7). Locate Shanghai, and then find Yang-chow. Locate the Yangtze River. Do you recognize any other locations on the map from Hudson Taylor's story?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.118 where the aftermath of a battle scene is described, as well as p.121-122 where Hudson and his friend are attacked by a drunken man.

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

The Luckiest Man Alive

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.124-135 "The mandarin nodded" - "the tile roof."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Hudson Taylor as a Missionary in China

Do you think Hudson Taylor's choice to dress similar to how a Chinese man would dress at the time a good idea? Why or why not?

WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1

20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Answers to Prayers

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.136-145 "Hudson fit right" - "very sick man."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.135-136 where war is discussed.

WEEK 2

20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

How to Reach China?

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.147-158 "Hudson, Maria cuddling" - "took a collection."

- Do you think Hudson's idea of reaching China with 24 missionaries was a good idea? What do you think about his decision to never ask for money to help with the ministry?

WEEK 3

20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

The Journey to China

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.158-169 "Now it was" - "into their bunks."

• IMPORTANT DATES

1865 - Hudson Taylor begins China Inland Mission (CIM)

WEEK 4

20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

A Difficult Journey

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.170-180 "For two nights" - "nearby ships thought."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Hudson Taylor & His Wife with a Group of Chinese Christians

What do you notice about this picture? What do you notice about the clothing and shoes the group is wearing?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1905 - Hudson Taylor dies

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

The Work Begins

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Yes, We Part, But Not Forever

View the hymn titled "Yes We Part, But Not Forever." Mentioned in yesterday's reading, the missionaries sang it together as they parted ways. Read the words (optionally, if someone is able to, play the melody so you can hear the tune). How do you think this hymn comforted the hearts of the missionaries?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.181-193 "Mr. Brunton traveled" - "and became fruitful."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.184 where Taylor's young daughter Grace dies. Preview the rest of the chapter as the mob chants untruths about the missionaries and threatens to kill them.

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

A Man in Christ

Materials: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.195-204 "By Christmas 1869" - "heart of China."

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: History of OMF

View the short video on the history of OMF International (the current name of Hudson Taylor's China Inland Mission).

WEEK 7 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

The White Ma and the Royal Canoe

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

NOTE: p.5 has a short explanation of how the authors adapted stories from Slessor's life for the book.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ INTRO

Our next book in this year's Church History is about Mary Slessor, a woman who left Scotland to be a missionary in Calabar, which is in West Africa.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.9-18 "Pressing her body" - "the missing goat."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Acts 3 in Efik language

Imatu is surprised when Mary can speak in the Efik language. Visit the link to hear verses from Acts 3 spoken in the Efik language.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.17-18 where mention is made of the chief being drunk.

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

"Run, Ma, Run!"

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor, wall map or globe

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ MAP WORK

∞ Map Link: Map of Nigeria

Find Nigeria in West Africa on your wall map or globe. Use your map or globe or visit the link to find Calabar, a city in what is now the country of Nigeria.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.19-27 "Chief Edem was" - "Run, Ma, Run!"

• When you read about how Mary Slessor talks to the children, or to the men helping her bring the supplies, or to the chiefs of the villages, what is your reaction? Do you think she is brave? Do you think she is not making very good choices, putting herself in danger? Or is there a different way you would describe Mary?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview passage on p.19 where mention is made of the drinking at the funeral and of the drunk chief. Preview p.20 where worship of the "angry spirits" is mentioned.

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

What Would White Ma Do?

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ VIEW IMAGE

∞ Image Link: Mary Slessor, Missionary

→ READ & NARRATE

p.28-36 "Dropping her slate" - "her voice quivering."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.28 and p.30 where the belief regarding twins is discussed. This is a main point in the book, as Mary Slessor works hard to save twins from death.

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

A Prank Goes Wrong

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-45 "We lived in" - "give one less!"

• The punishments used by the chief are harsh. What do you think of Mary Slessor's actions to stand up for Imatu to reduce the punishment?

WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
→ CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor	

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Mary Tries to Help the Chief

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.45-53 "Imatu's whole body shook" - "have all disappeared!"

- Does it make sense that the chief would blame someone else for his pain and injury? How would you respond in this situation if you were trying to calm down the chief?

WEEK 2 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

Exiled

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.54-63 "Ma Slessor scrambled" - "to the palaver."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the sentence on p.60 regarding the Aros warriors being cannibals. The sentence can be skipped.

WEEK 3 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Basket Trading

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.63-71 "Ma expressed her" - "with each other!"

- What do you think about Mary Slessor's idea of making baskets to trade?

★ TEACHER NOTE

On p.63, the word "cannibal" is used to describe the warriors. On p.70-71, trading gin and drinking are referenced.

WEEK 4 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

"Jesus Can Change Someone's Life!"

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.71-79 "The stack of" - "They were off."

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

The Chief's Son

Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ VIEW IMAGE

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

∞ Image Link: Mary Slessor with some of her children
What do you notice about this picture? What do you notice about what the children and Mary are wearing?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.79-88 "The trip down" - "of the forest."

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30 *The Regal Corpse*

📖 Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP
What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.89-97 "Driven by terror" - "to keep watch."

★ TEACHER NOTE
Preview p.95-97 where it mentions drinking and the people becoming drunk.

WEEK 7 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31 *Baby in the Bush*

📖 Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP
What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE
p.98-106 "Imatu was awakened" - "the thick darkness."

• What kinds of lessons do you think the character of Imatu is learning just by watching Mary Slessor's life and how Mary interacts with people and deals with all these events?

WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32 *Trial by Poison*

📖 Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP
What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE
p.107-117 "Imatu looked around" - "shape was gone."

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33 *No More Vengeance*

📖 Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

→ RECAP
What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.118-128 "Imatu held her" - "instead of death."

• What was your response to Chief Edem speaking to Mary Slessor and thanking her? Were you surprised? Why or why not?

Church History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34 Moving Forward Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor → RECAP What do you recall about last week's reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.129-137 "The church school" - "down the trail."	
WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35 Catch-Up Day Materials: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor → RECAP What do you recall about last week's reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Catch up on any reading in order to complete the book, Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor. Optional: Read "More About Mary Slessor" p.138-144, for further biographical info on Mary's life.	• IMPORTANT DATES 1915 - Mary Slessor dies
WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor	

Church History: Grades 4-6

Examination

- Term 1** · Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China: What are three obstacles Hudson Taylor faced after his decision to become a missionary in China?
- Term 2** · Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China or Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor: Tell a story you remember of a blessing or good thing that happened to either Hudson Taylor or Mary Slessor in their lives as missionaries.
- Term 3** · Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor: Tell what you remember about Mary Slessor's life as a missionary.